

Flattery

Saints should not use it.

Job 32:21-22 Let me not, I pray you, accept any man's person, neither let me give flattering titles unto man. 22 For I know not to give flattering titles; in so doing my maker would soon take me away.

Ministers should not use it.

1 Thessalonians 2:5 For neither at any time used we flattering words, as ye know, nor a cloke of covetousness; God is Witness:

THE WICKED USE, TO

Others.

Psalm 5:9 For there is no faithfulness in their mouth; their inward part is very wickedness; their throat is an open sepulchre; they flatter with their tongue.

Psalm 12:2 They speak vanity every one with his neighbour: with flattering lips and with a double heart do they speak.

Themselves.

Psalm 36:2 For he flattereth himself in his own eyes, until his iniquity be found to be hateful.

HYPOCRITES USE, TO

God.

Psalm 78:36 Nevertheless they did flatter him with their mouth, and they lied unto him with their Tongues.

Those in Authority.

Daniel 11:34 Now when they shall fall, they shall be holpen with a little help: but many shall cleave to them with flatteries.

False Prophets and Teachers use.

Ezekiel 12:24 For there shall be no more any vain vision nor flattering divination within the house of Israel.

Romans 16:18 For they that are such serve not our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly; and by good words and fair speeches deceive the hearts of the simple.

Wisdom, a preservative against.

Proverbs 4:5 Get wisdom, get understanding: forget it not; neither decline from the words of my mouth.

Worldly advantage obtained by.

Daniel 11:21-22 And in his estate shall stand up a vile person, to whom they shall not give the honour of the kingdom: but he shall come in peaceably, and obtain the kingdom by flatteries. 22 And with the arms of a flood shall they be overflowed from before him, and shall be broken; yea, also the prince of the covenant.

Seldom gains respect.

Proverbs 28:23 He that rebuketh a man afterwards shall find more favour than he that flattereth with the tongue.

Avoid those given to.

Proverbs 20:19 He that goeth about as a talebearer revealeth secrets: therefore meddle not with him that flattereth with his lips.

danger of.

Proverbs 7:21-23 With her much fair speech she caused him to yield, with the flattering of her lips she forced him. 22 He goeth after her straightway, as an ox goeth to the slaughter, or as a fool to the correction of the stocks; 23 Till a dart strike through his liver; as a bird hasteth to the snare, and knoweth not that it is for his life.

Proverbs 29:5 A man that flattereth his neighbour spreadeth a net for his feet.

Punishment of.

Job 17:5 He that speaketh flattery to his friends, even the eyes of his children shall fail.

Psalms 12:3 The LORD shall cut off all flattering lips, and the tongue that speaketh proud things:

Exemplified.

Woman of Tekoah,

2 Samuel 14:17 Then thine handmaid said, The word of my lord the king shall now be comfortable: for as an angel of God, so is my lord the king to discern good and bad: therefore the LORD thy God will be with thee.

2 Samuel 14:20 To fetch about this form of speech hath thy Servant Joab done this thing: and my lord is wise, according to the wisdom of an angel of God, to know all things that are in the earth.

Absalom,

2 Samuel 15:2-6 And Absalom rose up early, and stood beside the way of the gate: and it was so, that when any man that had a controversy came to the king for Judgment, then Absalom called unto him, and said, Of what city Art thou? And he said, Thy Servant is of one of the Tribes of Israel. 3 And Absalom said unto him, See, thy matters are good and right; but there is no man deputed of the king to hear thee. 4 Absalom said moreover, Oh that I were made Judge in the land, that every man which hath any suit or cause might come unto me, and I would do him justice! 5 And it was so, that when any man came nigh to him to do him obeisance, he put forth his hand, and took him, and kissed him. ...

False Prophets,

1 Kings 22:13 And the messenger that was gone to call Micaiah spake unto him, saying, Behold now, the words of the Prophets declare good unto the king with one mouth: let thy word, I pray thee, be like the word of one of them, and speak that which is good.

Darius's courtiers,

Daniel 6:7 All the presidents of the kingdom, the Governors, and the Princes, the counsellors, and the Captains, have consulted together to establish a royal statute, and to make a firm decree, that whosoever shall ask a petition of any God or man for thirty days, save of thee, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions.

Pharisees, ect.

Matthew 12:14 Then the Pharisees went out, and held a council against him, how they might destroy him.

Tyrians, ect.

Acts 12:22 And the people gave a shout, saying, It is the voice of a god, and not of a man.